

Christopher Stipes

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ENGINEERING LEADER

Backend & Platform Engineering | Scaling Teams & Systems | Quality & Reliability | Observability | GenAI Readiness

Engineering leader with 12+ years of experience across backend, platform, QA, and mobile engineering. Proven track record of scaling teams, modernizing infrastructure, and building resilient, observable systems. Passionate about developer velocity, testing in production, and high-impact platforms. Hands-on technical background with a people-first leadership style. Now focused on integrating Generative AI into quality engineering, automation, and performance strategies to drive engineering velocity and resilience.

CORE SKILLS

- **Programming & Frameworks:** Go, Python, Ruby, JavaScript, gRPC/Protobuf, GraphQL - Quality & Automation: Playwright, Appium, Cypress, Detox, Selenium, Postman, custom Go/Python test frameworks
- **Performance & Reliability:** Locust, Grafana k6, Artillery, Observability-driven testing, CI/CD quality gates
- **Cloud & Platforms:** AWS (S3, Lambda, SNS/SQS), Docker, Microservices, Snowflake
- **GenAI & Data:** Prompt engineering, ML/AI quality evaluation, LLM-based test design (emerging), Python-based ML benchmarking tools

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fetch Rewards

Digital Receipts Tech Lead / Backend Engineer | May 2024 – Aug 2025

- Scaled system to process 1.5–2M digital orders daily, transforming it into a reliable, market-ready data product.
- Reduced incident frequency from multiple per month to near-zero, dramatically improving stability and reliability.
- Successfully doubled user base across iOS and Android platforms from 18% of active users to 39%.
- Created a Python-based ML benchmarking tool to evaluate and validate model accuracy, enabling continuous improvements in receipt classification.

Director of Quality Engineering / SDET | Nov 2022 – May 2024

- Directed QA organization of 40+ manual QA and SDETs, leading managers and senior ICs. - Established weekly release cadence across iOS and Android platforms.
- Championed observability-driven testing strategies, embedding quality into production workflows. - Drove adoption of Appium (mobile), Playwright (React web), and Go/Python-based data testing frameworks.
- Promoted internally for delivering high-impact org-wide quality initiatives and metrics

Shipt

Engineering Manager / Backend Engineer | Oct 2020 – Nov 2022

- Re-architected Ad-tech platform to support multiple vendors with mediation and high availability. - Improved relevancy and placements, helping grow ad revenue ~15%.
- Drove GraphQL adoption, replacing bloated legacy APIs.
- Implemented contract/schema validation between frontend/backend at build time. - Doubled team size through hands-on hiring and mentorship.
- Senior Backend Engineer | Oct 2019 – Oct 2020
- Rebuilt “Shelf” service in Go with modular extensibility as a headless CMS, achieving 20% performance gain and unlocking new features.
- Partnered with Data Science to accelerate recommendation engine updates. - Built CMS tooling enabling non-engineers to launch branded content.
- Migrated large portions of Ruby monolith to microservices.

QA Manager / SDET | Jun 2018 – Oct 2019

- First dedicated SDET hired with mandate to shift QA team to engineering team
- Postman-based testing with embedded microservice test frameworks. - Introduced Cypress (web) and Detox (mobile) for end-to-end testing.
- - Developed a load testing framework using Locust + Grafana integrated into backend service reports. - Built UI-driven data validation system for product ingestion and search relevance.

Guidewire Software

Lead SDET | Jun 2015 – Jun 2018

- Built the company's first test automation framework for native mobile + web using Appium + Selenium in Java.
- Created Excel-based tooling for non-technical users to create test scenarios and execute via webapp
- Integrated Artillery load testing into all microservice templates.

EDUCATION

University of Alabama – B.A., 2007